

J&A AUTOMATION LLC · FIELD ENGINEERING

FIELD TECHNICIAN & ENGINEERING OPERATIONS GUIDE

Complete daily guide for industrial controls engineers, robot programmers, and field technicians. Learn how to log daily hours with decimal precision, file shift progress reports, upload reimbursable expense receipts, and track your biweekly compensation payouts.

FIELD PERSONNEL & ENGINEERING ROLE · CLIENT ESSENTIAL RELEASE

System Information:

J&A Employee Operations Portal

Field Version: 2026.09

Mobile PWA & Industrial Tablet Compatible

Guaranteed Worker Privacy:

Worker compensation privacy strictly enforced.

Client billing rates, company profit margins, and other workers' rates are completely hidden.

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Field Worker Operational Rules Checklist

Operational Area	Standard Requirement	How to Follow in the Portal
Standard Shift	10 hours per day, Monday through Saturday (60 hours/week standard).	Log actual shift duration with decimal precision (e.g. 10.0, 8.5) in <i>Time</i> .
Standby Hours	When waiting for plant parts, line clearing, or customer authorization.	Select category <i>Standby</i> and describe the idle cause in notes.
Shift Reports	Mandatory daily report for plant handover and safety records.	Submit a <i>Field Report</i> before leaving the factory site.
Travel Expenses	Receipt photo required for all travel expenses (hotel, fuel, flights).	Attach receipt image in <i>Expenses</i> and verify amount and currency.
Compensation Statements	Personal statements for earnings and tax records.	Access <i>My Pay</i> to view settlements and download statement PDF/CSV.

1. INTRODUCTION, DAILY RESPONSIBILITIES & WORKER PRIVACY FIREWALL

Welcome to the **J&A Automation Field Operations Portal**. As an industrial controls engineer, robotics specialist, or electrical commissioning technician, your work on the plant floor drives our company's reputation and success.

This portal provides you with an intuitive, mobile-ready tool to record your working hours, submit daily shift progress, attach travel expense receipts, and track your biweekly compensation payouts.

The Worker Privacy Firewall (CORE-01 & CORE-05): The J&A platform enforces strict separation of internal technician compensation from client billing. You will only ever see your own agreed compensation rate and earnings. Company profit margins, client billing rates (\$70/h, \$55/h), client invoices, and other workers' compensation are completely inaccessible to your user account.

Your Daily Responsibilities on Site

1. **Time Logging:** Record your actual worked hours and standby hours at the end of every shift with decimal precision.
2. **Daily Field Report:** Summarize work completed, machine status, problems encountered, and safety checks before leaving the plant.
3. **Receipt Uploads:** Submit clear photos of receipts for hotel, fuel, flights, or car rentals as soon as they are incurred.
4. **Settlement Verification:** Review approved compensation, hours breakdown, and payout dates in *My Pay*.

2. DAILY WORKFLOW, NAVIGATION & MOBILE PWA ACCESS

When you sign into the platform, the **Today Dashboard** immediately presents your planned shift, active project assignment, and quick action shortcuts.

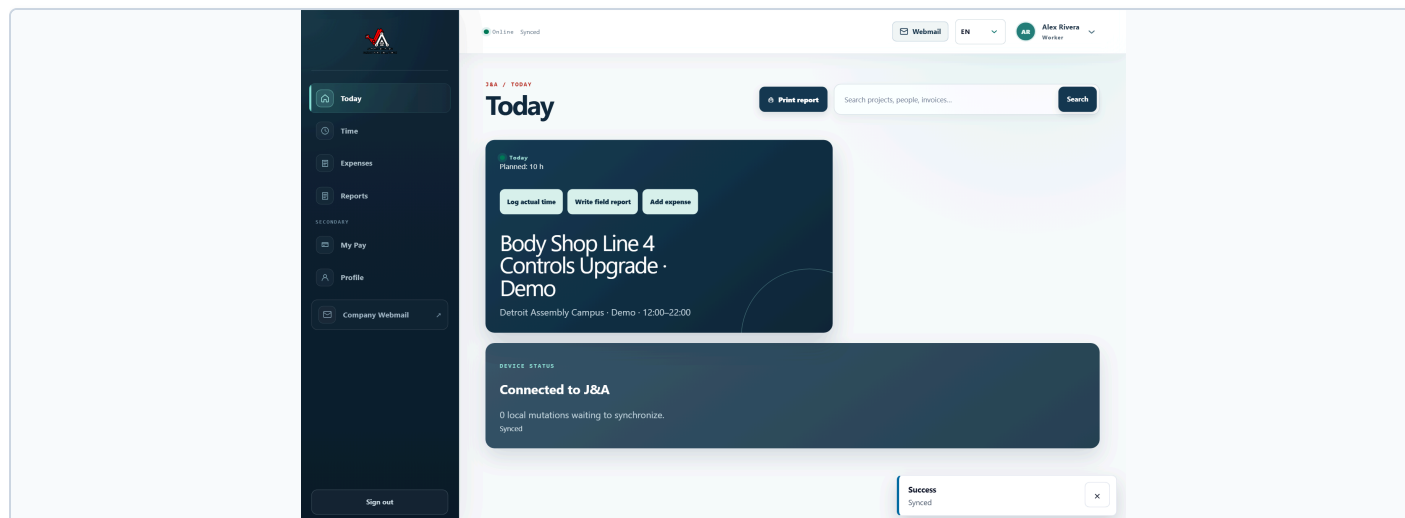


Figure 2.1: Worker Today Dashboard showing planned hours (10h), active project assignments, and quick actions.

Mobile Field Use (Progressive Web App)

The portal is fully optimized for mobile devices and industrial tablets, allowing you to enter hours and file reports directly from the plant floor:

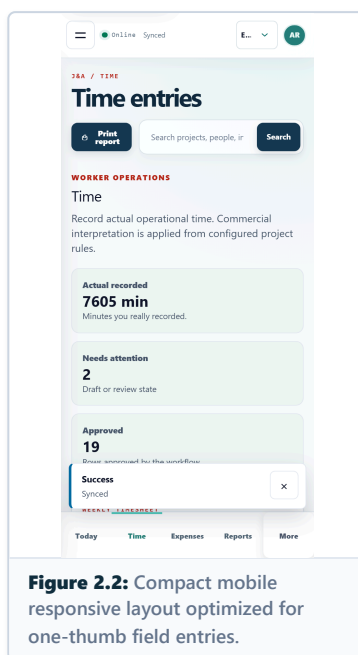


Figure 2.2: Compact mobile responsive layout optimized for one-thumb field entries.

Worker Navigation Menu Breakdown

Navigation Item	Icon	URL Route	What You Can Do
Today	🏠	/app/today	Shift overview, current project assignments, quick action buttons.
Time	🕒	/app/time	Log daily shift hours, submit weekly timesheets, copy prior week.
Expenses	💎	/app/expenses	Submit out-of-pocket expenses and upload receipt photos/PDFs.
Reports	📋	/app/reports	File daily field reports, log PLC program changes and plant blockers.
My Pay	\$	/app/pay	View approved gross pay, hourly rate, settlement dates, and download PDF stubs.
Profile	👤	/app/profile	Manage account, register biometric passkeys, change language.

3. DAILY TIME LOGGING WITH DECIMAL HOURS & STANDBY RULES (CORE-04)

Accurate time entry ensures your hours are promptly approved by Project Managers and processed for biweekly settlement without delays.

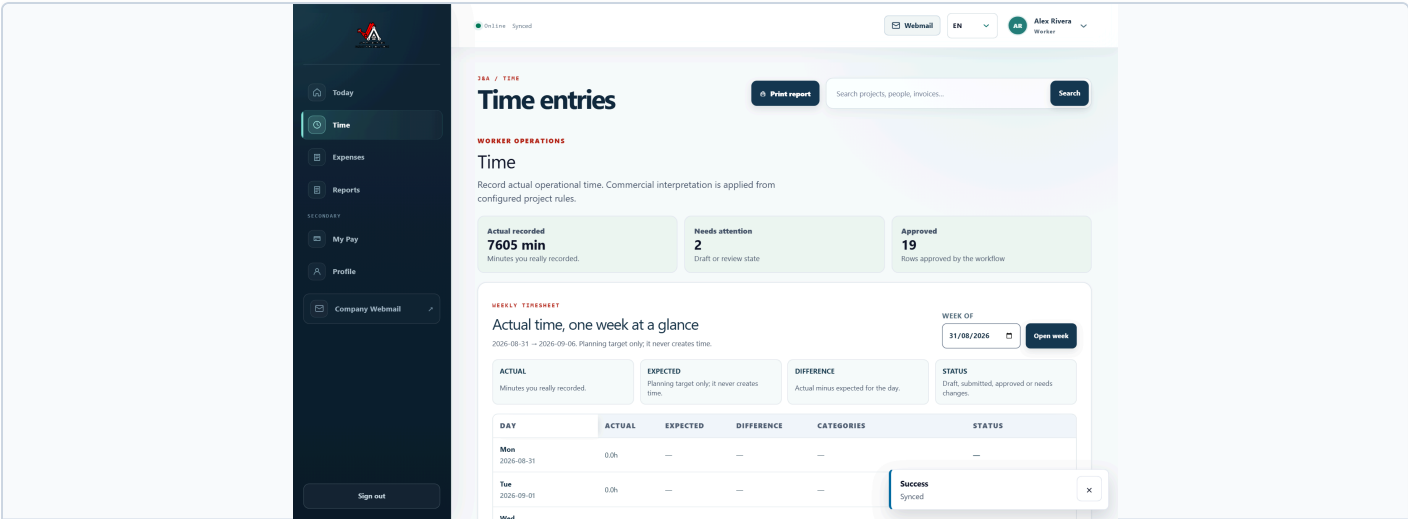


Figure 3.1: Time Tracking interface showing daily shift entry, project picker, and weekly calendar breakdown.

Time Logging Form: Every Input Box Explained

Field Label	Input Type	Database Target	How to Fill Out & Validation Rules
Work Date	<input type="date">	time_entry.work_date	Date on which the shift was performed. Must be within your active assignment dates.
Project	<select>	time_entry.project_id	Dropdown listing only the active projects you are currently assigned to (e.g. CP020 · BBS Mexico).
Hours Worked	<input type="number">	time_entry.duration_minutes	Decimal Hours: Enter exact shift duration (e.g. 10.0, 8.5, 7.25). Converted to exact minutes in SQLite (hours × 60).
Work Category	<select>	time_entry.category	Dropdown with 4 options: regular, overtime, travel, standby.
Task Description	<textarea>	time_entry.description	Detailed task description (e.g., "PLC debugging on Station 20 turntable interlocks").

Work Category Dropdown Options Explained

- Regular Commissioning (regular):** Standard on-site engineering, robot programming, PLC coding, and electrical debugging.
- Overtime (overtime):** Extended site work exceeding 10 hours in a single day or 60 hours in a single workweek.
- Travel Time (travel):** Transit time flying or driving to the customer plant site.
- Standby / Idle Time (standby):** On-site waiting time due to customer line stoppages, missing machine parts, or safety halts. Must describe the reason in notes.

4. WEEKLY TIMESHEET LIFECYCLE: DRAFT, SUBMIT & APPROVAL STATES

Timesheets follow a deterministic lifecycle designed to protect your hours and ensure prompt approvals by Project Managers.

Timesheet Status Indicators & Meaning

Status Badge	What It Means	Can You Edit It?	Next Step
DRAFT	Entry is saved locally in your portal.	Yes (Full edit/delete).	Complete shift hours for the week and click <i>Submit Week for Approval</i> .
SUBMITTED	Locked for editing. Sent to Project Manager for review.	No (Locked).	Awaiting Project Manager review and approval.
APPROVED	Validated by PM. Officially queued for biweekly settlement.	No (Permanent).	Visible in <i>My Pay</i> dashboard for upcoming direct deposit payout.
Rejected	PM requested corrections. Rejection note explains reason.	Yes (Unlocked for fix).	Read PM note, correct the hours/description, and re-submit.

All Buttons in Time Section Explained

Button Label	Action	When to Use It
Save Draft Entry	Saves daily row.	Click at the end of each shift to store hours without submitting yet.
Submit Week for Approval	Locks timesheet.	Click at the end of Saturday (or last day worked) to send entire week to PM.
Copy Prior Week	Clones layout.	Click on Monday to copy the project rows from last week with 0.0h, saving typing.
Delete Draft	Removes row.	Click to discard an erroneous draft entry before submission.

5. SUBMITTING DAILY FIELD REPORTS & GENERATED REPORT PDF (CORE-07)

Customer plant managers and J&A leadership rely on your daily report for shift handovers, machine issue tracking, and safety compliance.

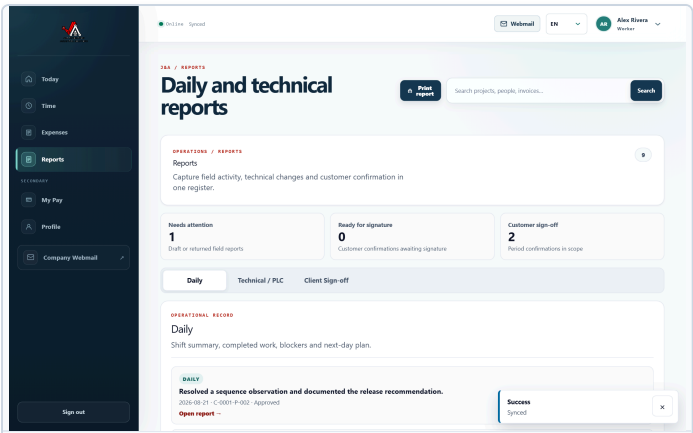


Figure 5.1: Field Reports web form for entering tasks, blockers, and safety observations.

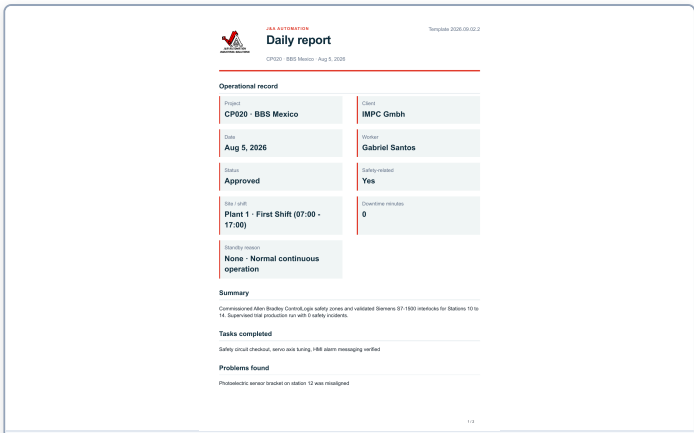


Figure 5.2: Generated Daily Field Report (PDF) compiled by the system for plant handover records.

Field Report Input Fields & Database Columns

Field Label	Input Type	Database Column	Operational Guidelines
Report Date	<input type="date">	daily_report.report_date	Date of the shift being reported.
Project	<select>	daily_report.project_id	Customer project where field service was performed.
Shift Summary	<textarea>	daily_report.summary	Describe stations, robots, and software logic worked on today.
Roadblocks & Blockers	<textarea>	daily_report.blockers	Document missing customer parts, mechanical delays, or tooling faults.
Safety Observations	<textarea>	daily_report.safety_notes	Note any safety gate bypasses, LOTO procedures, or electrical hazard checks.
Next Day Plan	<textarea>	daily_report.next_day_plan	Handover instructions for tomorrow's shift or the incoming engineering team.

Submit Daily Report : Compiles and submits official report. **Download PDF** : Downloads official formatted shift report.

6. LOGGING REIMBURSABLE EXPENSES & UPLOADING RECEIPTS (CORE-06)

If you pay out of pocket for travel, fuel, lodging, or emergency job site hardware, submit them in the **Expenses** section for 100% reimbursement in your next settlement.

Figure 6.1: Expense Submission form with receipt upload, vendor selection, and reimbursable checkbox.

Expense Input Fields & Categories Explained

Input Box / Dropdown	Field Name	Database Target	Options & Instructions
Spent On (Date)	incurredOn	expense.incurred_on	Date printed on the physical or digital receipt.
Project	projectId	expense.project_id	Project for which the expense was incurred.
Category	category	expense.category	Dropdown: lodging (hotel), meals (food/per diem), travel_transit (flights, car rentals, gas), mileage, materials_tools (emergency cables/tools), other.
Amount	amount	expense.amount_minor	Exact total amount paid on receipt (decimal, e.g. 142.50).
Currency	currency	expense.currency	Select transaction currency: USD, EUR, MXN, CAD.
Merchant / Store	merchant	expense.merchant	Vendor name (e.g. <i>Chevron Gas</i> , <i>Hertz Car Rental</i> , <i>Home Depot</i>).
Attach Receipt File	receiptFile	expense.receipt_storage_key	Upload photo (JPG, PNG) or PDF invoice. Must be legible showing date and amount.

Save Expense Draft : Stores draft locally. **Submit Expense** : Submits for reimbursement approval. **Delete Draft** : Discards unsubmitted draft.

7. MY PAY: TRACKING COMPENSATION & GENERATED STATEMENT PDF/CSV (CORE-05)

The **My Pay** dashboard provides 100% transparency into your earnings, approved hours, and scheduled payout dates.

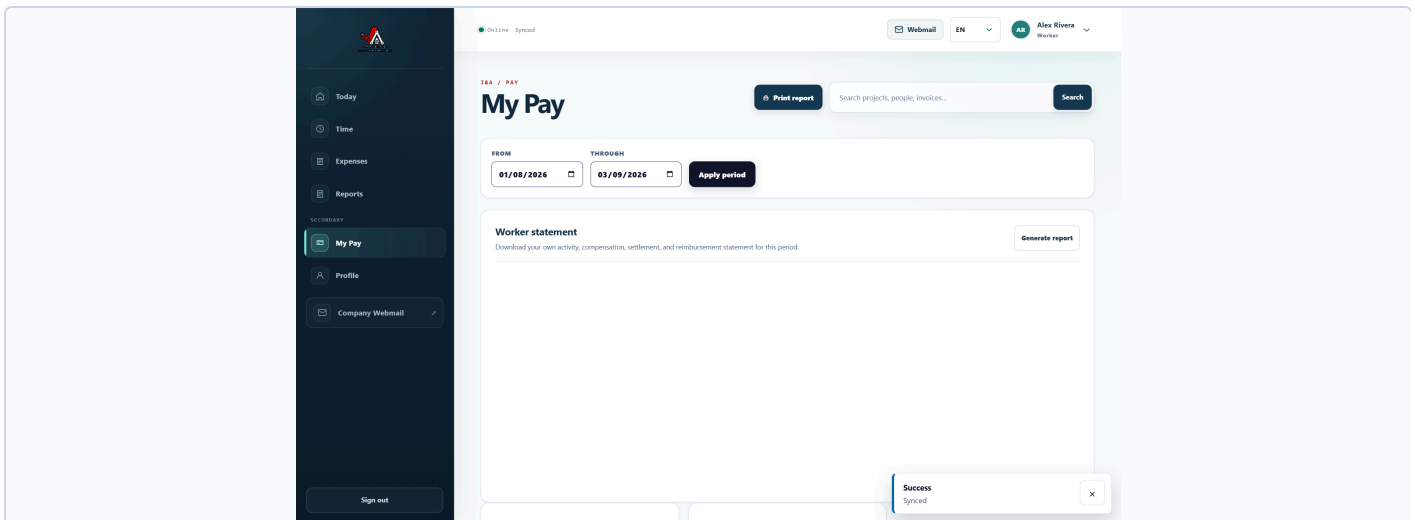


Figure 7.1: Worker Pay panel showing Approved Compensation (\$5,260.00), Approved Reimbursements, and Settlement payout history.

Generated Official Statement (PDF) & Personal Excel Export (CSV)



Figure 7.2: Generated Worker Compensation Statement (PDF) showing 131.50 hours, \$40.00/h rate, and \$5,260.00 payout.



Figure 7.3: Exported Personal Compensation Spreadsheet (Worker_Statement_Gabriel_Santos.csv) for tax records.

Understanding Your Compensation Dashboard

- **Approved Hours:** Total hours validated by PM for the current pay period (e.g. 131.50 h).
- **Hourly Rate:** Your agreed internal compensation wage (e.g. \$40.00 / h). Private to you.
- **Gross Labor Earnings:** Approved Hours × Hourly Rate (\$5,260.00).
- **Expense Reimbursements:** Approved travel receipts added 100% to your payout without tax withholding.
- **Payout Schedule:** Direct ACH bank transfer date.

Download Statement PDF: Official J&A pay stub artifact. **Export CSV**: Spreadsheet export for tax accounting.

8. DOCUMENTS HUB, SAFETY RESOURCES & TECHNICAL DRAWINGS

The Documents Hub provides instant access to plant electrical schematics, PLC program backups, and factory safety protocols.

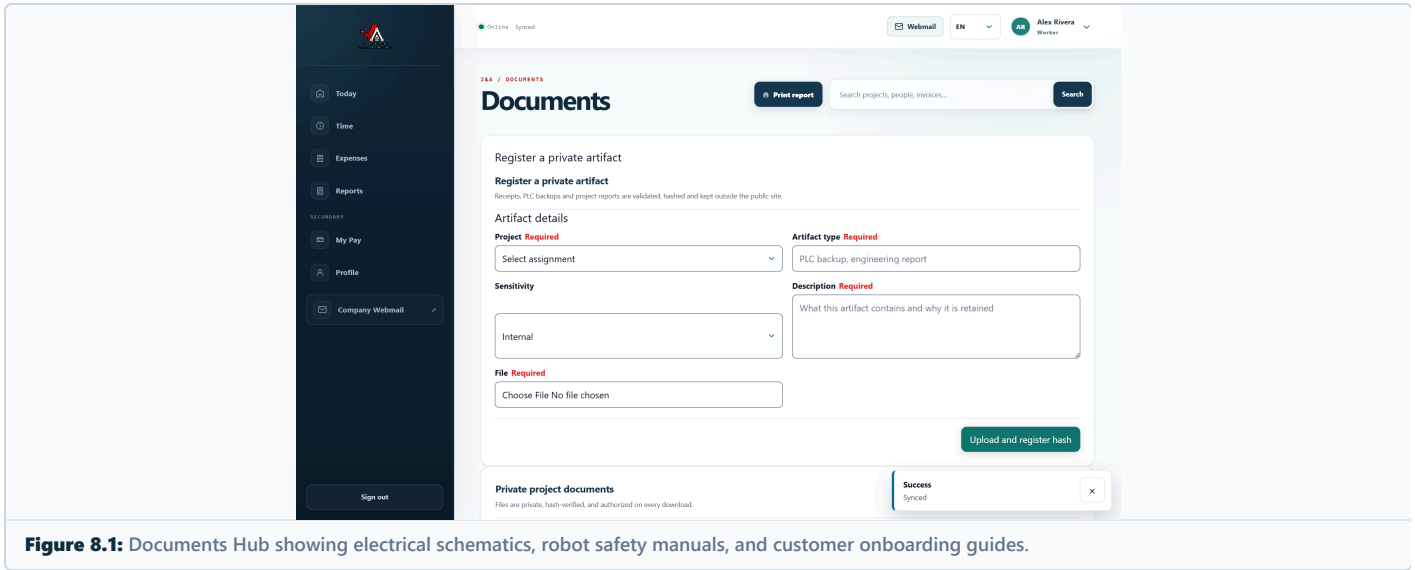


Figure 8.1: Documents Hub showing electrical schematics, robot safety manuals, and customer onboarding guides.

Key Document Categories for Field Engineers

Category	Typical Contents	Allowed Formats
Electrical Schematics	EPLAN schematics, I/O rack distributions, 24V power distribution.	PDF, DWG
PLC & Robot Backups	TIA Portal .zap18 archives, Rockwell .acd projects, Fanuc backup files.	ZIP, ZAP, ACD
Plant Safety Protocols	Customer LOTO (Lockout/Tagout) rules, emergency evacuation, arc flash PPE.	PDF

Offline Storage: Download required schematics before traveling to customer plants with poor mobile reception.

9. ACCOUNT SECURITY: BIOMETRIC PASSEYS, MFA & LANGUAGE SETTINGS

Protecting your account and logging into the field portal quickly is seamless with modern biometric passkeys and language personalization.

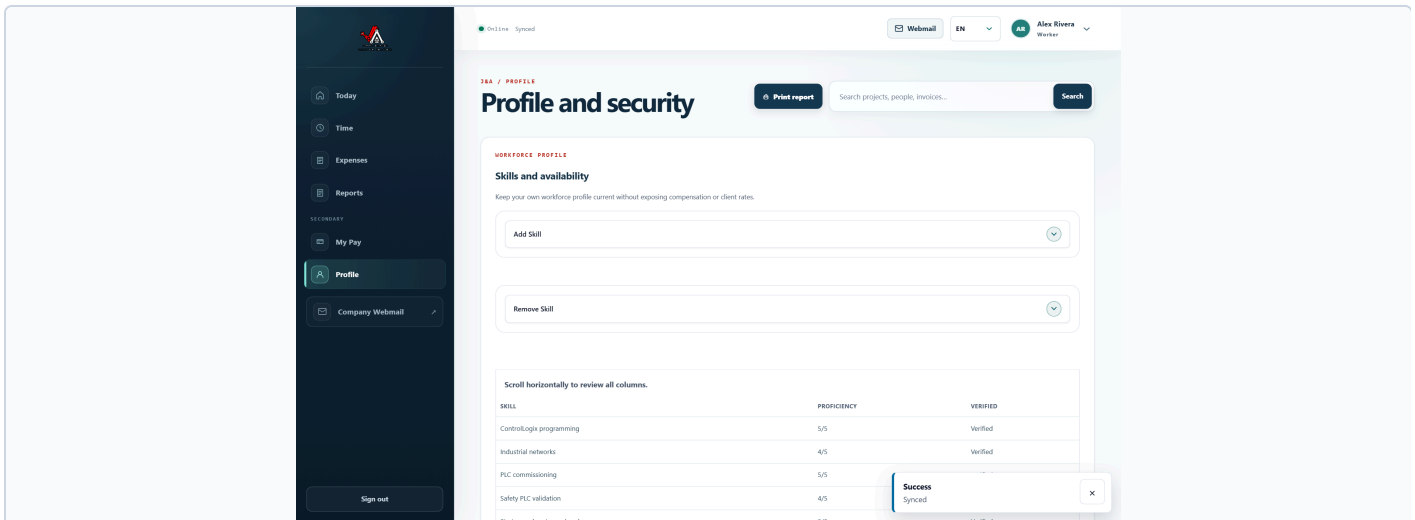


Figure 9.1: Worker Profile settings panel showing passkey registration, MFA authenticator setup, and language picker.

Profile Settings Inputs & Security Controls

Setting / Input	Type	Options & Instructions
Interface Language	<select>	Select your preferred language: English , Español (Spanish), or Português (Portuguese). All forms and badges translate instantly.
Password Change	Password inputs	Enter current password, new password (min 8 chars), and confirmation.
Register Passkey	WebAuthn Button	Enrolls your device biometric hardware (TouchID, FaceID, Windows Hello). Allows single-touch instant login.
Setup Authenticator App	MFA Modal	Scans QR code with Google Authenticator or 1Password to activate 6-digit backup codes.

Lost Phone / Device Support: If you lose your phone on site, contact field.operations@j-aautomation.com immediately to reset your authentication session.